Sensory Processing Disorder

Inclusion Toolkit

Symptoms

- Over or under-sensitive to things like sounds, lights, touch, and smells.
- Difficulty filtering background noise.
- Emotional dysregulation when overwhelmed.

Age & Gender

- Often identified in early childhood.
- Diagnosed more often in males.
- Females are often missed due to masking.

Common myths

- It’s not bad behaviour. Sensory input is genuinely overwhelming.
- Not the same as autism, though they often co-occur.
- Not something people can overcome just by trying harder.

Diagnosis

- It isn't a separate diagnosis in the Diagnostic and Statistical Manual of Mental Disorders, the main book doctors use to diagnose conditions.
- Often identified by an occupational therapist.
- Frequently co-occurs with other conditions.

Professional support

- Sensory integration therapy with an Occupational Therapist.
- A personalised 'sensory diet' of daily activities.
- Changes to the surroundings to reduce things like noise and bright light.

How to help

- Offer quiet or low-stimulation workspaces.
- Reduce sensory triggers like flickering lights.
- Allow headphones, sunglasses, or fidget tools.

This information isn't a diagnostic tool. If you recognise these symptoms in yourself or others, please contact a doctor.